

ENG 101

Lesson – 34

An introduction has four **purposes**:

1. **Introduce** the topic of the essay.
2. Give a general **background** of the topic.
3. Specify the overall, '**plan**' of the essay.
4. Arouse the reader's **interest** in the topic.

If you remember the introductory paragraph has two parts: (i) General statements (ii) A thesis statement

1 Anyone born in the twentieth century will have seen a lot of changes take place in nearly every aspect of human life. 2 While some found these changes fascinating, others found them discomforting and they want to return to the simpler, less mechanical life style of the past. 3 On the one hand the twentieth century brought about a higher standard of living, on the other it brought along pollution, the weakening of human relationships and the diminishing of spiritual and moral values.

The **thesis statement**: (i) states the main topic
(ii) lists the subdivision of the topic
(iii) may indicate method of organization of essay
(iv) is usually the last sentence of the introductory paragraph.

Practice 1:

In the following 3 introductory paragraphs the sentences in each are not in the correct order.

Rearrange the sentences beginning with the most general statement first until the introduction becomes more specific. The thesis statement should come last.

(A) 1 Lahore's heavy traffic problems can be solved by building under and overhead passes along the canal roads, by improving the public transport system within the city, and by building rapid transit systems from the rural areas to the city. 2 Traffic congestion is caused by the thousand of cars, vans and buses that come into the city from the neighboring small towns as well as from the thousands of cars that come from within the city limits. 3 One of the most serious problems that Lahore faces with is traffic congestion. 4 This huge problem must be solved before it gets worse.

Correct order: _____

(B) 1 However, in others, the nuclear family i.e. only parents and their dependent children living in one household is the rule. 2 People in different cultures have different systems for family life.

3 In many cultures, people live in extended families in which three generations share the same house. 4 In all parts of the world the family system is undergoing great changes. 5 In Pakistan too, the traditional family system, the extended family is rapidly giving way to the nuclear family and this could have enormous effects on our society.

Correct order: _____

(C) 1 From observing animal behavior to measuring radio signals from celestial objects in space, scientists have tried different methods to predict earthquakes, but have so far been unsuccessful. 2 Earthquakes are the most catastrophic of natural disasters in terms of loss to human life and property. 3 Despite advancements in scientific knowledge and technology

scientists are still not able to predict earthquakes.

4 This paper will examine the history of the science of earthquake prediction, then discuss each of the methods in more detail, and finally present data indicating the success - failure ratios of each method.

Correct order: _____

Practice 2.

Study these following thesis statements. Which method of organization (chronological order / comparison and contrast) does each one indicate? Beginning from the pre-Independence period and continuing through the period immediately after Independence, the status of women in Pakistan has changed remarkably. _____

(b) Despite the set backs in the Zia period, the status of women in Pakistan has improved considerably but it is still very low when compared to the status of women in the west. _____

Practice 3.

The following are thesis statements, in which both the method of organization and the major subdivision of the topic are indicated. Each subdivision will be the topic of a paragraph in the main body. Read the statement and say (i) what will be the topics of each paragraph (ii) how many paragraphs will the essay probably contain?

The status of women in Pakistan has changed notably in the past decade due to increased educational opportunities and economic independence.

No of paragraphs (____) : _____

_____ (b) The role of women in Pakistani society

has undergone great changes especially in the areas of political participation, economic self reliance and job opportunities.

No of paragraphs (_) - _____
- _____
- _____

Practice 4:

Look at the following thesis statements. The main topic is underlined and the subtopics are in brackets. Indicate the words or punctuation marks that are used to introduce the subtopics.

Capital punishment should be abolished not only because it deprives a human being of life but also because it does not stop crime.

Topic: _____

Sub Topic : _____

Words that introduce sub topic:

(ii) Women are likely to live longer than men for two reasons: they lead less stressful lives and they look after their health.

Topic - Women live longer than men

Sub Topic _____

Words that introduce sub topic.: _____

(iii) We protect domestic animals because they are valuable to use materially and emotionally.

Topic: _____

Sub Topic _____

S.T. Introductory words _____

Practice 4.

Complete the following thesis statements by adding topics to them. If you use correlative conjunctions (both, and , no only... but also) make sure your structures are parallel.

(i) This life expectancy of the average person is increasing because of _____

(ii) Technology is changing our lives in three important areas: _____

iii) Foreign learner of English have problems with three sounds: _____

(iv) Nobody likes watching television commercials

(v) A good teacher must have the following qualities:

The concluding paragraph consists of :

a summary of the main points **OR**

(ii) a restatement of your thesis statement

in different words **AND**

(iii) Your final comment on the topic of your essay.

Model Essay. Look at the **introduction** and **conclusion** for the following model essay on 'The Advantages and Disadvantages of Living in the Twentieth Century'.

(Introduction) Anyone born in the twentieth century will have seen a lot of changes take place in nearly

even aspect of human life. While some find these changes fascinating, others find them discomforting and they want to return to the simpler, less mechanical life style of the past. While on the one hand the twentieth century brought about a high standard of living, on the other it brought along pollution, the weakening of human relationships and the diminishing of spiritual and moral values.....

.....
(Conclusion) *In conclusion*, although the twentieth century has indeed given us a lot of advantages by making us more moneyed, healthier and freer to enjoy our

lives, it has, in my opinion, not made us, any more sensible and happier. The twentieth century has also made the earth dirtier, the people less humane and our spiritual lives miserable. We should continue to enjoy the benefits of modern technology because they release us from the drudgeries of manual work and allow us the freedom to pursue our interests and objectives. However, we must make collective efforts to preserve the earth's natural environment for future generations. Also, we should try to build relationships with other fellow beings. In a world which is increasingly becoming more and more impersonal and mechanized.

Practice 5.

Write concluding paragraphs for the following introductions by summarizing the main points or

paraphrasing the thesis statement or adding your own final comments as a final message to the reader.

Introduction 1: Modern life is creating health problems. Stress affects nearly everyone, from the highly pressurized administrator to the busy housewife or student. It can cause a variety of physical disorders, ranging from headaches to stomach ulcers. Stress is not something that can be cured self-medication like the common cold. However, it can be controlled. One can learn to control stress by enjoying a good laugh and or going for long walks, and by maintaining warm relationship with friends, family and colleagues.

Conclusion 1:

In the end we can say that although stress, a feature of modern life, causes many physical disorder in the human body, it can be controlled by enjoying a good laugh, going for long walks and by maintaining warm relationships with friends, family and colleagues. **In my opinion to control stress we need to cultivate cheerfulness for our own sake.**

Introduction: 2.

Television is the most popular form of entertainment in Pakistan. People of all ages from all walks of life enjoy watching television. It has been estimated that the average Pakistani watches tv for an average of four hours daily. Thus, tv has had a tremendous influence on its viewers, especially children. Doctors are now of the view that children are adversely effected by constantly watching tv. This is due to the

fact that they do not take part in physical activities, spend less time reading, and are constantly exposed to a world of violence that can affect their immature personalities.

Conclusion 2:

To sum up it can be said that effects of television especially on children are not beneficial. Doctors think that being glued to the mini-screen for many hours at a stretch watching violence has adverse effects. It will not only affect their physical health and eye sight but also their personalities.

